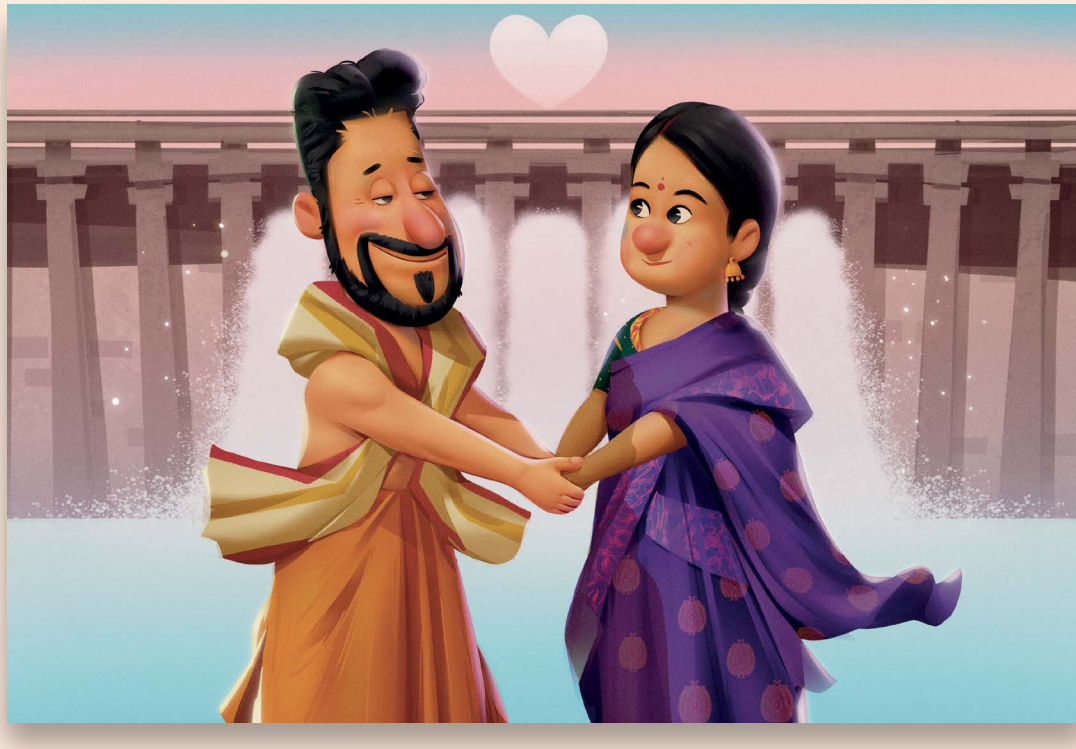
▼ GLASSHOUSE



OF FAITH AND LOVE

Telangana's current and former chief minister may disagree on virtually everything, but **Revanth Reddy** and K. Chandrasekhar Rao share a faith in the power of yagnas to keep the state prosperous. During his two terms, KCR staged elaborate, days-long Vedic rituals seeking divine assistance. Earlier this month, Revanth, accompanied by wife **Geetha**, performed a Maha Varuna Yagam, organised by the Congress government to pray for abundant rainfall during an El Niño year. Conducted at the depleted Nagarjuna Sagar reservoir, the ritual featured *homams* by 108 *ritviks* (priests). The venue also had sweeter memories for the couple; sources say the CM and his wife first met there over three decades ago and fell in love. The couple also posed for pictures, briefly mixing prayers for rain with a little nostalgia.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ SP AUDITS EX-ALLY

SMALL CHANGE

Akhilesh Yadav appears to have reopened old political wounds with a rather colourful assessment of his former ally, Union minister **Jayant Chaudhary**. Taking an apparent dig at the Rashtriya Lok Dal (RLD) chief, the Samajwadi Party president said, "*Hum logon ne chavanni ka rupaiya bana diya, phir bhi hamein chhod kar chale gaye*", implying they had multiplied his political fortunes, but even then he left them. The RLD, which won just one seat in the 2017 UP assembly polls on its own, had got eight in 2022 after joining hands with the SP. Jayant and his men, though, moved to the BJP-led NDA ahead of the 2024 Lok Sabha election and won both the seats the party contested. Akhilesh's remark now has got the RLD all worked up, which felt it was an insult to the memory of Chaudhary Charan Singh, the late former prime minister and Jayant's grandfather (who himself was no stranger to political intrigue) and the party's core base, the farming community of western UP.

